Malte H. Hinrichs

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Education

PhD in Economics 10/2023–present
Queen's University Belfast, UK
Affiliated with: Centre for Economics, Policy and History (CEPH)
Dissertation Title: *Water, Wheels, and the Wealth of Nations: Geography and Path Dependence in European Industrialization*
Viva: 21/10/2026 (Passed with no corrections; highest possible outcome)

MSc Economics 09/2020–09/2022
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *Engines of Growth? The Role of the Steam Engine for Long-Run Economic Development in Germany*

Visiting Student 02/2021–06/2021
NHH Norwegian School of Economics, Norway

BSc Economics 09/2017–08/2020
University of Mannheim, Germany
Thesis: *The Long-Term Effects of Colonialism on Income Inequality*

Visiting Student 08/2019–12/2019
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong

Publications

"Water mills and human capital accumulation in industrialising Prussia" 07/2026
Explorations in Economic History, 101(1): 101767.
Article: doi:10.1016/j.eeh.2026.101767
Replication Package: doi:10.17632/pvnh7g4b39.2

Job Market Paper

"Leapfrogging or path dependence? Water mills and long-run growth in the Scottish Industrial Revolution"
Latest draft available on my website.

Abstract: Does technological change favour agile entrants or adaptable incumbents? I study Scotland's industrialisation to test whether steam power allowed new locations to leapfrog centres of water power. Using a newly constructed dataset linking over 1,200 pre-industrial mills to parish-level outcomes, and an instrumental variable strategy based on geographic endowments, I reject the leapfrogging hypothesis. Each additional mill in 1755 increased long-run population growth by about 8

Working Papers

"Market access without roads: First-nature geography and European city growth, 700–1800"
Draft available upon request.

Teaching Experience

Queen's University Belfast

Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (course design, tutorials)	09/2025–01/2026
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam supervision, marking)	09/2024–01/2025

University of Mannheim

Macroeconomics A, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	02/2020–08/2020
Statistics II, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, student mentoring)	09/2019–12/2019
Principles of Economics, Teaching Assistant (tutorials, exam organisation)	09/2018–12/2018

Honours and Awards

Winner, Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition, Queen's University Belfast 04/2026

New Researcher Prize, Economic History Society 04/2026

Graduated in top 20% of MSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim 09/2022

Graduated in top 10% of BSc Economics cohort, University of Mannheim 08/2020

Dean's List, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology 12/2019

Research Grants and Funding

Santander Career Support Award 05/2026

Economic History Society New Researcher Conference Bursary 01/2026

EHES Conference Travel and Accommodation Grant 07/2025

Economic History Society Young Scholar Conference Bursary 01/2025

CEPH Studentship, Irish Higher Education Authority, full funding for PhD studies 10/2023

PROMOS Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service, full funding for HKUST 06/2019

Professional Memberships

Economic History Society (UK)

European Historical Economics Society

Irish Economic Association

Academic Presentations

Invited Talks

Graduate Seminar in Economic and Social History, University of Oxford 05/2026

Economic History Seminar, University of Hohenheim 03/2026

Department of Economics Seminar Series, Heriot-Watt University Edinburgh 01/2026

Centre for Economic History Seminar Series, Queen's University Belfast 04/2024

Conference and Workshop Presentations

CEPH PhD Workshop, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference, Queen's University Belfast 05/2026

Economic History Society Conference, London School of Economics 04/2026

Irish Postgraduate and Early Career Economics Workshop, Maynooth University 01/2026

European Historical Economics Society Conference, University of Hohenheim 09/2025

CEPH Workshop in Quantitative Economic History, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

Queen's Postgraduate Research Conference, Queen's University Belfast 06/2025

Economic History Society Conference, University of Strathclyde 04/2025

Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group, Queen's University Belfast 02/2025

Centre for Economic History PhD Discussion Group, Queen's University Belfast 03/2024

Professional Development

Graduate Teaching Assistant Workshop, The Economics Network 01/2025

Economic History Society Residential Training, University of Warwick 11/2024

Financial, Economic and Business History Summer School, University of Groningen 06/2024

Workshop for Teaching Assistants, University of Mannheim 09/2018

Public Engagement

'Die Kraft des Wassers: Deutschlands vergessene Industrialisierung' 08/2026
Featured Interview, GEO Magazine (Germany)

'Chatting GPT: What does history tell us about the future of AI?' 10/2025
Invited Speaker, ESRC Festival of Social Science

Industry Experience

KPMG AG Wirtschaftsprüfungsgesellschaft
Junior Consultant, Global Transfer Pricing (Mannheim, Germany) 04/2023–09/2023

Technical Skills

Econometric & Spatial Methods: Causal Inference (IV/2SLS, DiD, Panel/FE), Spatial Econometrics, GIS & Cost-Surface Analysis, Gravity Modelling

Software & Programming: R (`sf`, `terra`), Python, Stata, Matlab, QGIS, Git, Quarto, LaTeX

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Latin (reading)

References

Chris Colvin (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
chris.colvin@qub.ac.uk · Website

Carsten Burhop (External PhD Examiner)
Rheinische Friedrich-Wilhelms-Universität Bonn
burhop@uni-bonn.de · Website

Alan Fernihough (PhD Supervisor)
Queen's University Belfast
a.fernihough@qub.ac.uk · Website

John Turner (CEPH Director)
Queen's University Belfast
j.turner@qub.ac.uk · Website

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